

Seasonic entry

Seasonic enters the Indian power supply market and is gaining popularity

Wireless power

Nagano Power Radio demonstrates 95 per cent efficiency wireless power transfer across a distance of 40 cm

Agent 001

Q I'm a computer science student and I need to buy a laptop within a budget of Rs. 40,000. I'm also interested in a little gaming; please suggest a good performance laptop.

Abhinav Kumar

A I recommend a Dell Inspiron 14 based notebook if you want something remotely portable; otherwise look at the Inspiron 15 that has the larger 15.6-inch display. The 15.6-inch Inspiron 15 can be had for as little as Rs. 35,000 while the Inspiron 14 will come close to your Rs. 40,000.

Q I would like to purchase a branded iPod ranging from Rs. 500 to Rs. 1,500. Kindly recommend me which iPod I should purchase, and please mention the key features. I don't know any more about iPod except that it is used to play music.

Vishnu Thakor

A Firstly I'd like to clear one misconception – the word “iPod” is an Apple patent and iPods are made by Apple Inc. Every other player in the market is not called an iPod; you should refer to them as PMPs, i.e. portable multimedia players. For Rs. 1,500 you can pick up the Yes YMP-17 1 GB. It's a decent PMP and has a two-colour OLED display and is microSD expandable. Transferring MP3 files is as easy a drag 'n' drop.

Q I have the following system – processor: dual core @ 2.0 GHz, motherboard: Jetway 946, RAM: Zion 1 GB DDR2, graphic card: ATI Radeon HD 3450 512 MB, SMPS: Iball 500W, cabinet: Iball. I use Windows 7 RC1 received with Digit June issue. I am currently using an Acer AC713 CRT monitor. I need to buy a 17-inch LCD monitor within a budget of Rs. 6,000-6,500 for general purposes. Is the Dell S1709W or the Samsung 740NW a good option, or should I look for other brands? Also, does my rig need to be upgraded to

play games like NFS undercover, Far Cry 2, Fifa 2009 at maximum resolution and details?

Sanjib Das

A You have not mentioned whether your processor is a Core 2 Duo or a Pentium D. Either way your PC is not suited for playing the latest games, especially Far Cry 2. You will need to upgrade your memory and graphics card first. For Rs. 3500 you can pick up 4 GB of DDR2 RAM in a 2 x 2 GB kit. Your graphics card should be the next component you upgrade. If you want to go crazy you can spend around Rs. 6,500 and pick up a GeForce 9800GT – which is superb for that price. Later on you might want to buy a Core 2 Duo E8400 (3.0 GHz), priced at Rs. 8,400, this will ensure your GPU doesn't get bottlenecked. For a monitor, refer to our August issue where we tested LCD monitors. In case you missed it, for Rs. 8,700 you can pick up an AOC 2236Vw, a 22-inch monitor. For Rs. 7,500 Acer's P205H is another good pick, it's a 20-inch LCD with good performance.

Q I would like to buy a new mobile. My budget is Rs. 10,000. The features I expect are 3G enabled, Wi-Fi (optional), 3.2 MP (2 MP is also ok), Good music, good battery back up and it should look good.

Prabhu V

A I believe Sony Ericsson's K810i is still available. Although an older model it has many features for the price, and the street price should be in the range of Rs. 9,000

Q I have a shoe string budget of Rs. 6,500 for motherboard and processor. I will be highly obliged if you let me know the best combination

Saurav Chowdhury

A The ASUS NVIDIA 7025 M2N68-AM

motherboard for Rs. 2,250 coupled with the AMD Athlon XP X2 6000+ for Rs. 2,850 is a sweet combo that will be affordable yet powerful enough. It's also well within your budget.

Q I have a few issues on buying:

1) A friend said that desktops deteriorate when there is moisture in the air (rainy season). Is it true?

2) My father wants to buy a laptop and I will use it only for gaming; which are good gaming laptops near the 30 to 44 thousand bracket?

3) What would be better – a gaming laptop or desktop?

Prajwal K

A Moisture does gradually corrode the surface of cabinets, power supplies, etc., if they are not properly coated, and moisture can cause short circuits inside your cabinet, but generally this does not happen if your PC is used regularly. It's a good idea to plug out and pack stuff up if you will not be using it for some time, say, more than a couple of weeks. You can alternatively stick sachets of silica gel to the inside of your cabinet as this absorbs the moisture and helps delay its ill effects. Gaming laptops are costlier than that. You can get a general-purpose notebook for that price but if you want to play games the Dell Studio XPS 16 is the bare minimum you should look at. I recommend buying a desktop PC – you will get a more powerful configuration.

Q Please suggest the best half-height graphics for my 250-watt PSU

Satish S

A A GeForce 8400GS should be sufficiently inexpensive. Do check last month's issue where we tested a lot of entry level cards. You're sure to find something suitable. **A**



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